

work-car-travel-playbook

The Work / Car / Travel Playbook™

The Correct Move Wherever You Are — Not Just At Home

Why this worksheet exists: Most earthquake prep focuses entirely on the home — but you spend roughly half your waking hours somewhere else: the office, the car, traveling, at the gym, in a store. This playbook covers the moves and prep for every place you're likely to be, so the system travels with you.

How to run it: Read through each scenario once. Do the one-time prep items (work bag, car kit tie-in) this week. Review before any trip.

Scenario 1 — At Work / The Office

One-time prep: - [] Know your building's emergency evacuation plan and meeting point (ask HR/ facilities if you don't already know it) - [] Keep a small personal kit at your desk: comfortable shoes (if you wear heels/ dress shoes), a granola bar, a small flashlight, any daily medication - [] Know where the stairwells are — do NOT plan to use elevators during/after

During: drop, cover, hold on under your desk or against an interior wall, away from windows and tall filing cabinets/shelving.

After: follow your workplace's evacuation plan if instructed. Use the stairs. Text your out-of-area contact and household once safely outside. Do not drive home immediately if roads may be congested/damaged — assess first.

Scenario 2 — In the Car

One-time prep: Your car kit from Tool #3, Section 7 — water, first aid, cash, comfortable shoes, phone charger.

During: - [] Pull over as quickly and safely as possible - [] Avoid stopping under or on overpasses, bridges, near buildings, trees, or power lines - [] Stop, put the car in park, keep your seatbelt on, and stay inside — the car's frame offers real protection from falling debris - [] Turn on the radio for official updates while you wait

After: Check for damage to roads/bridges before continuing. Avoid downed power lines and damaged infrastructure. If a bridge or overpass looks damaged in any way, do not cross it — find another route or wait for official clearance.

Scenario 3 — Public Transit (bus, train, subway)

During: - [] Stay seated, brace against the seat in front of you, and cover your head/neck - [] If standing, grab a stable handhold and crouch low - [] Do not attempt to exit a moving vehicle

After: Follow the operator/conductor's instructions. If evacuation is ordered, move calmly to the nearest safe exit, watching for gaps, debris, and other passengers. Text your check-in as soon as you're safely off and clear of the area.

Scenario 4 — Shopping / Retail / Public Buildings

During: drop, cover, hold on — get away from shelving units, glass display cases, and heavy signage, which are common tip-over/fall hazards in retail spaces. Get under a sturdy table/checkout counter if available, or against an interior wall.

After: follow store staff instructions for evacuation. Watch for fallen merchandise and broken glass underfoot on your way out. Do not use elevators or escalators.

Scenario 5 — Gym / Pool / Recreational Facility

During: move away from windows, mirrors, and heavy equipment racks (weight racks are a real tip-over risk). Drop and cover under something sturdy if available, or against an interior wall. If in a pool, exit the water as quickly and calmly as possible — pools can slosh violently (seiche effect) during shaking.

After: follow facility staff instructions. Check for broken glass (mirrors, windows) before walking barefoot.

Scenario 6 — Traveling / Hotel Stays

One-time prep before any trip: - [] Note your hotel room's exit route (stairwell location) when you check in — make this a habit, every trip - [] Pack a mini version of your go-bag essentials: flashlight, whistle, a day of water/snacks, any critical medication, a copy of your ID - [] Share your itinerary with your out-of-area contact before you leave

During: same universal move — drop, cover, hold on, away from windows and tall furniture (hotel dressers/TVs are often not anchored the way your own home now is).

After: use stairs, not elevators, to evacuate if instructed. Follow hotel staff and local official instructions — you're less familiar with the area's specific risks (tsunami zones, structural quality) than a local, so lean on local guidance.

Scenario 7 — Coastal Areas (traveling or living)

Additional rule beyond the universal move: if you feel strong or prolonged shaking while at or near the coast, **move to higher ground or inland immediately after the shaking stops** — do not wait for an official tsunami warning if the quake itself was strong; natural warning signs (a strong quake felt near the coast) come before official alerts in many cases. Confirm safety with official sources once you're on higher ground, not before moving.

The One-Page Quick Card (cut out, keep in wallet/bag)

WHEREVER YOU ARE: DROP. COVER. HOLD ON. Away from windows/tall objects.

DRIVING: pull over away from overpasses/lines, stay in car, seatbelt on.

COASTAL: after shaking stops, move to higher ground immediately.

ALWAYS: text (don't call) your out-of-area contact once safe.

The Verdict Sheet

- **Work evacuation plan known?** Y / N
 - **Car kit stocked (Tool #3, Section 7)?** Y / N
 - **Travel mini-kit packed for next trip?** Y / N
 - **Coastal rule understood by all household members?** Y / N
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Pro Tips From the Field

1. **The 5-second habit for any new place:** glance for the nearest sturdy table/ desk and the nearest stairwell the moment you arrive somewhere. This becomes automatic with repetition and costs zero extra time.
 2. **Frequent flyers/road warriors:** keep the travel mini-kit permanently packed in your travel bag so trip prep never skips this step.
 3. **If you work in a high-rise, know the specific “shelter” floors/zones** your building has designated — many high-rises have specific interior refuge areas.
 4. **Teach teenage drivers the car protocol explicitly** — “pull over away from overpasses” is not obvious to a new driver and is worth a specific conversation.
 5. **Revisit this playbook before any trip to an unfamiliar seismic region** — risk awareness that's automatic at home needs a conscious refresh when traveling.
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Your Next Step

You have the playbook. Now execute: do the one-time prep items (work kit, car kit, travel mini-kit) this week. Then move to the **12-Week Quake-Ready Tracker (Tool #8)** to turn this entire system into a maintained habit instead of a one-time read.

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your workplace's specific emergency plan.*